METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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# MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Key Issue

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# Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Opportunities in Nutrition & Health is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their positioning to meet market demand for products with improved nutritional or health profiles.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

**Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy**

| 3 Pillars | 10 Themes | 33 ESG Key Issues |
|---|---|---|
| Environmental | Climate Change | Carbon Emissions |
| | | Climate Change Vulnerability |
| | | Financing Environmental Impact |
| | | Product Carbon Footprint |
| | Natural Capital | Biodiversity & Land Use |
| | | Raw Material Sourcing |
| | | Water Stress |
| | Pollution & Waste | Electronic Waste |
| | | Packaging Material & Waste |
| | | Toxic Emissions & Waste |
| | Environmental Opportunities | Opportunities in Clean Tech |
| | | Opportunities in Green Building |
| | | Opportunities in Renewable Energy |
| Social | Human Capital | Health & Safety |
| | | Human Capital Development |
| | | Labor Management |
| | | Supply Chain Labor Standards |
| | Product Liability | Chemical Safety |
| | | Consumer Financial Protection |
| | | Privacy & Data Security |
| | | Product Safety & Quality |
| | | Responsible Investment |
| | Stakeholder Opposition | Community Relations |
| | | Controversial Sourcing |
| | **Social Opportunities** | Access to Finance |
| | | Access to Health Care |

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| 3 Pillars | 10 Themes | 33 ESG Key Issues |
|---|---|---|
| | | Opportunities in Nutrition & Health |
| Governance | Corporate Governance | Board |
| | | Pay |
| | | Ownership & Control |
| | | Accounting |
| | Corporate Behavior | Business Ethics |
| | | Tax Transparency |

## Opportunities associated with this Key Issue

- Increased revenue from growing demand for nutritional and healthier products.
- Reputational damage and fines resulting from controversies related to false marketing claims.

## Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Key Issue score

The Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, opportunities on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such the Exposure score determines the weight placed on the Management score, ranging from 50% (when the Exposure score is equal to zero) to 100% (when the Exposure score is equal to 10).

$$KI_i = \left(\left(\frac{EXP_i}{20} + .5\right) \times MGMT_i\right) + \left(\left(.5 - \frac{EXP_i}{20}\right) \times 5\right)$$

Where:

- $KI_i$ is the Key Issue score for company $i$.
- $EXP_i$ is the Exposure score for company $i$.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company $i$.

## Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

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| Component | Sustainability Indicator |
|---|---|
| Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Practices score | In-house innovation capacity to develop healthier products |
| | Strategy to develop natural and healthy products |
| | Food & beverage nutrition enhancement programs score |

## Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management score

The Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by Controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice and 0 corresponding to lack of management. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company $i$.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator $j$ for company $i$.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator $j$ for company $i$.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component $c$, for company $i$.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator $j$ for company $i$.

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- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator $j$ for company $i$.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component $c$.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component $c$ for company $i$.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company $i$.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component $c$.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

## Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Practices score

The Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Practices score evaluates the company's ability to manage opportunities related to its positioning to meet market demand for products with improved nutritional or health profiles. This score is equal to the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Management score (excluding controversies) and considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **In-house innovation capacity to develop healthier products**

**Definition**: Indicates whether the company has resources dedicated to developing healthier and more natural products. Leading practice is to have dedicated research centers and staff to develop healthier products.

- **Strategy to develop natural and healthy products**

**Definition**: Indicates whether the company has a strategy to further develop natural and healthy products.

- **Food & beverage nutrition enhancement programs score**

**Definition**: Assesses the company's efforts to improve the nutritional profile of its food and beverage products. Highest performance reflects comprehensive programs to reduce artificial ingredients, fat, sodium, sugar, and portion size, enhance products through fortification and use natural ingredients. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

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- **Extent of programs to reduce artificial ingredients in food products**

**Definition**: The estimated share of revenues generated from food and beverage products that contain less or no artificial ingredients (e.g., preservatives, colorings, aspartame) or less or no controversial ingredients (e.g., antibiotics).

- **Extent of programs to reduce portion size**

**Definition**: The estimated share of revenues generated from products reformulated with reduced portions.

- **Extent of programs to reduce sugar in food products**

**Definition**: The estimated share of revenues generated from food and beverage products reformulated with less sugar.

- **Extent of programs to reduce fat in food products**

**Definition**: Indicates the estimated share of revenues generated from food/beverage products reformulated with less fat.

- **Extent of programs to reduce sodium in food products**

**Definition**: Indicates the estimated share of revenues generated from food/beverage products reformulated with less salt.

- **Extent of programs to enhance or fortify products to address nutrient deficiencies**

**Definition**: Indicates the estimated share of revenues generated from food/beverage products fortified to reduce nutrient deficiencies (e.g. vitamin A, zinc, iodine, iron).

- **Extent of initiatives to use more natural ingredients**

**Definition**: The estimated share of revenues generated from food and beverage products that are certified to organic standards.

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## Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- False marketing controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to the Controversies cases section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

# Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Exposure score

The Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest opportunity and 0 corresponding to the lowest opportunity. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

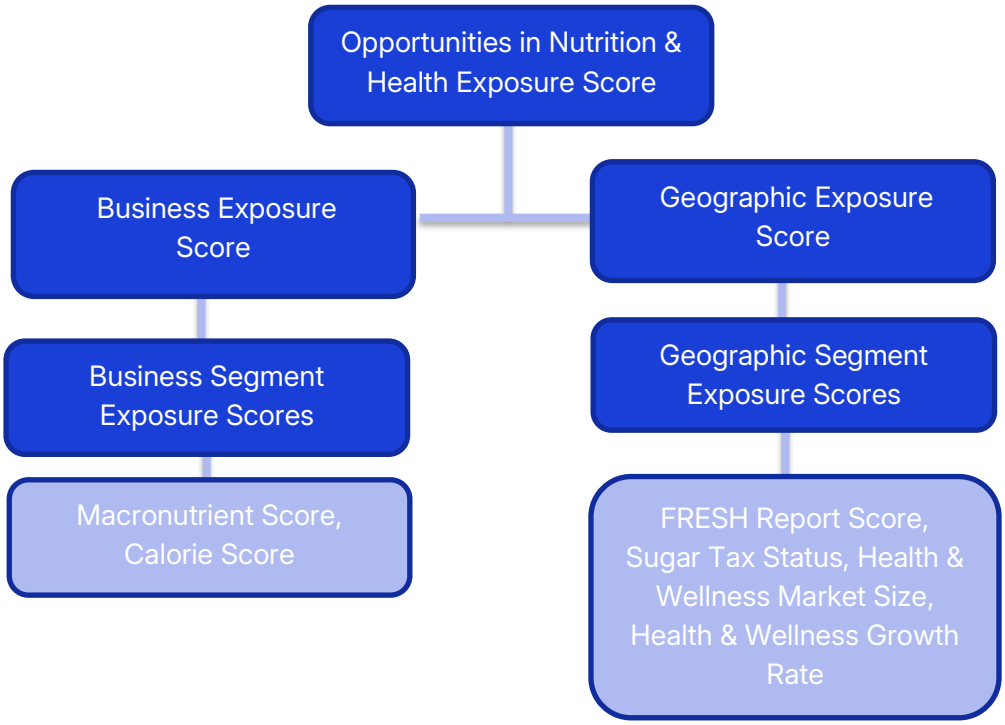
$$EXP_{ONH,i} = BUS_{ONH,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{ONH,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{ONH,i}$ is the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Exposure score of company $i$.
- $BUS_{ONH,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company $i$.
- $GEO_{ONH,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company $i$.

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**Exhibit 2: Exposure score components**




## Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment, using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{ONH,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{ONH,j}$$

Where:

- $BSE_{ONH,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for business segment $j$.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment $j$ for company $i$ based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- $n_i$ is the number of business segments of company $i$.

### Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the

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Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. Each business activity score is determined by the following formula:

$$BSE_{ONH,j} = Max\{CAL_{ONH,j}, MAC_{ONH,j}\}$$

Where:

- $CAL_{ONH,j}$ is the Calorie score for business activity $j$.
- $MAC_{ONH,j}$ is the Macronutrient score for business activity $j$.

The Calorie score is based on the recommended calorie intake (in kilocalories per day) for a given food category from the EAT-Lancet Commission Summary Report. The higher the number of calories recommended, the higher the Calorie score for a given food category, varying from 0 to 10.

The Macronutrient score is based on the recommended macronutrient intake (in grams per day) for a given food category from the EAT-Lancet Commission Summary Report. The higher the amount of macronutrients recommended, the higher the Macronutrient score for a given food category, varying from 0 to 10.

Business activities are mapped to food categories to which they cater. A higher score reflects a higher opportunity, given the higher intake recommendations.

## Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenues in each geographic segment using the following equation:

$$GEO_{ONH,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{ONH,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{ONH,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score in region $r$.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of total revenue in region $r$ for company $i$.
- $n_i$ is the number of geographic segments for company $i$.

For geographic segments reported as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{ONH,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{ONH,c}$$

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Where:

- $GSE_{ONH,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market $c$.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market $c$ within region $r$.

**Geographic Segment Exposure scores**

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by the following formula:

$$GSE_{ONH,c} = FRH_{ONH,c}\,(SUG_{ONH,c} + HWS_{ONH,c} + HWR_{ONH,c} + 1)$$

Where:

- $FRH_{ONH,c}$ is the FReSH Report score of country or market $c$.
- $SUG_{ONH,c}$ is the sugar tax multiplier of country or market $c$.
- $HWS_{ONH,c}$ is the health and wellness market size by population multiplier of country or market $c$.
- $HWR_{ONH,c}$ is the health and wellness market size growth rate multiplier of country or market $c$.

The FReSH Report score is derived from a qualitative assessment of the relevance of consumption behaviors, trends and food preferences by region, taken from the World Business Council for Sustainable Development's Food Reform for Sustainability and Health [FReSH] insights report on "Consumption Behavior and Trends."

The sugar tax multiplier, equal to 5%, is applied if a country or market has a sugar tax.

The health and wellness market size by population multiplier is variable (2%-10%) and is determined by the health and wellness market size in a given country or market relative to its total population.

The health and wellness market size growth rate multiplier is variable (2%-10%) and is determined by the annual growth rate of the health and wellness market size in a given country or market.

## Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Opportunities in Nutrition & Health Exposure score:

The EAT-Lancet Commission on Food, Planet, Health, Sustainable Food Systems: Summary Report; World Business Council for Sustainable Development's FReSH insights report on "Consumption Behavior and Trends;" Obesity Evidence Hub; the Organic Trade Association's consumption estimates data for organic packaged foods and beverages; Refinitiv; MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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